

James Hope

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Experienced product trainer with a strong background in customer service. Adept at designing and delivering engaging training programmes, fostering knowledge retention, and enhancing team performance. Highly organised and effective in dynamic, fast-paced environments; skilled at prioritising tasks and achieving objectives with creativity, enthusiasm, and a collaborative approach.

Experience

Customer Service Agent / Former Client Trainer, Sigma Connected, Work From Home – 2021 - Present

I currently support vulnerable customers with their energy accounts — updating personal information, setting up payment plans, and resolving enquiries and complaints. It requires patience and empathy, and I've been able to make a genuine difference for people during difficult periods. Before this, I worked as a Client Trainer within the same company, which was one of the most rewarding aspects of my time there. I onboarded new team members from day one, developed training materials, and delivered sessions that prepared them to take on the role confidently. Seeing someone I trained develop into the position and achieve their targets is something I'm proud of.

Customer Service Agent (Outbound), Sitel, Work From Home – 2020 - 2021

In this outbound role I proactively contacted clients on behalf of our client, gathered essential information, and provided guidance on next steps. The role required resilience and the ability to adapt my approach to different situations. I also took responsibility for supporting colleagues after challenging calls — a quick check-in or change of tone after a difficult conversation helped maintain team morale, and I became a point of contact for colleagues who needed to decompress.

Assistant Store Manager, Vodafone, Bridlington – 2020

I supported the Store Manager with day-to-day operations, trained and managed team members, and ensured we met our targets while maintaining a high standard of customer service. I held key holder responsibilities — opening and closing the store, conducting security checks, and reporting faults — which gave me a strong sense of accountability. The environment was fast-paced, but I performed well under pressure and learned to prioritise effectively.

Hotel/Restaurant Manager, The Star Inn, Bridlington — 2019 - 2020

I managed the daily operations of this hotel and restaurant, leading and coordinating teams to deliver a high standard of service. From front-of-house management to kitchen operations during peak periods, I was hands-on across all areas. I implemented service standards that raised the quality of the guest experience, and I ensured effective communication between departments to maintain consistency. Maintaining quality control and reputation required discipline, but I'm proud of the standards we achieved.

Customer Assistant/Theatre Technician, Parkway Cinema, Beverley – 2017 - 2018

This role combined customer service with live event technical support. On the service side, I sold tickets, served refreshments, guided patrons, and maintained a clean environment. The technical aspect involved supporting clients with lighting, sound, and audiovisual equipment for screenings and events. I found satisfaction in ensuring events ran smoothly and the technical delivery met expectations.

Customer Assistant, Clarks, Beverley - 2017

Working in a busy high street store, I assisted customers in selecting appropriate footwear and accessories — a task that requires patience and product knowledge, particularly during busy periods. I expanded my understanding of product care techniques and maintained well-stocked, visually appealing displays. The role developed my ability to read customers quickly and match them with suitable products.

Front Line Agent, 1st Locate, Scarborough - 2016 - 2017

This was a debt collection role that required professionalism and empathy in equal measure. I served a diverse range of clients, maintaining a respectful approach on every call. I addressed enquiries, resolved issues, and worked with individuals to establish realistic payment plans. The position reinforced the importance of handling sensitive conversations with care.

Customer Assistant, Tesco Superstore, Bridlington - 2011- 2016

I spent five years at Tesco, which provided a strong foundation in customer service. I served customers in a fast-paced supermarket environment, handled stock rotation, supported the warehouse team with deliveries, and maintained clean, well-stocked aisles. I worked as part of a team to achieve sales targets and found the experience rewarding.

Venue Technician, The Spa, Bridlington - 2007 - 2010

This was my first technical role, and it established the foundation for my career in live events. I managed lighting, sound, and AV equipment for clients leasing the theatre, Royal Hall, and conference rooms. I oversaw events from conception to completion — designing lighting layouts, programming and operating equipment, managing rigging and de-rigging, and ensuring compliance with health and safety. The variety was considerable: one day setting up for a conference, the next running lighting for a live performance. It taught me to think on my feet, remain calm under pressure, and always have contingency plans.

Education

BA in Contemporary Media, Design & Production (2016-2019)

Grade: 2:1

East Riding College, Beverley

MODULES: Digital technologies, Decoding the digital society, Animation techniques and principles, Digital video production, Digital image production, Professional development, Work based practice, Audience, Audio for contemporary media, 3D motion graphics, Independent study, Professional production, Live conference and exhibition, Web based portfolio.

HNC in Production & Technical Theatre (2005-2006)

Grade: Merit

Reid Kerr College, Paisley

MODULES: Preparation & Performance of sound Effects for Theatre - Pass, Providing Stage Props for Production - Pass, Set Construction, Painting and Finishing - Pass, Stage Lighting: Lighting Control/ Operation - Merit, Stage Lighting: Rigging - Merit, Stage Management Skills - Pass, Design for the stage - Pass

NQ2 Performing Arts (2004-2005)

Grade: Pass

Ayr College, Ayr

MODULES: Acting Skills - Pass, Acting: Text Based Production - Pass, Communications (NC) - Pass, Creative Project and Presentation - Pass, Dance: Choreography - Pass, Drama Theory and Practice - Pass, Group Dance Performance - Pass, Movement for Theatre Performers - Pass, Theatre Production Team - Pass, Voice - Pass, Appreciation of Dance - Pass, Video Skills: Presentation and Production - Pass

Standard Grades (2002-2004)

Mainholm Academy, Ayr

GRADES: Music - 1, Physics - 3, Maths - 3, English - 4.

Other Qualifications

- Apple Teacher (2017)
- Introduction to the Facilities Industry (NCFE Level 1)
- Employability Skills (NCFE Level 1)

Skills

Customer Service, Employee Training, Live Events, Event Production, Lighting Design, Stage Lighting, Video Production, Live Video Streaming, Video Editing, Professional Audio, Live Sound, Photography, Image Editing, Stage Management, Performing Arts, Music Production, Piano, Microsoft Office, CRM, Communication, Teamwork, Attention to Detail, Linux, Adobe Photoshop, CAD, Typing, Data Entry